

MetaCTF February 2026 Flash CTF Write-up



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Great Paywall

Great Paywall (solved by 391 teams)

100

Problem

Previous Submissions

I keep seeing this article shared on social media, but every time I try to read it I get this annoying paywall! Can you help?

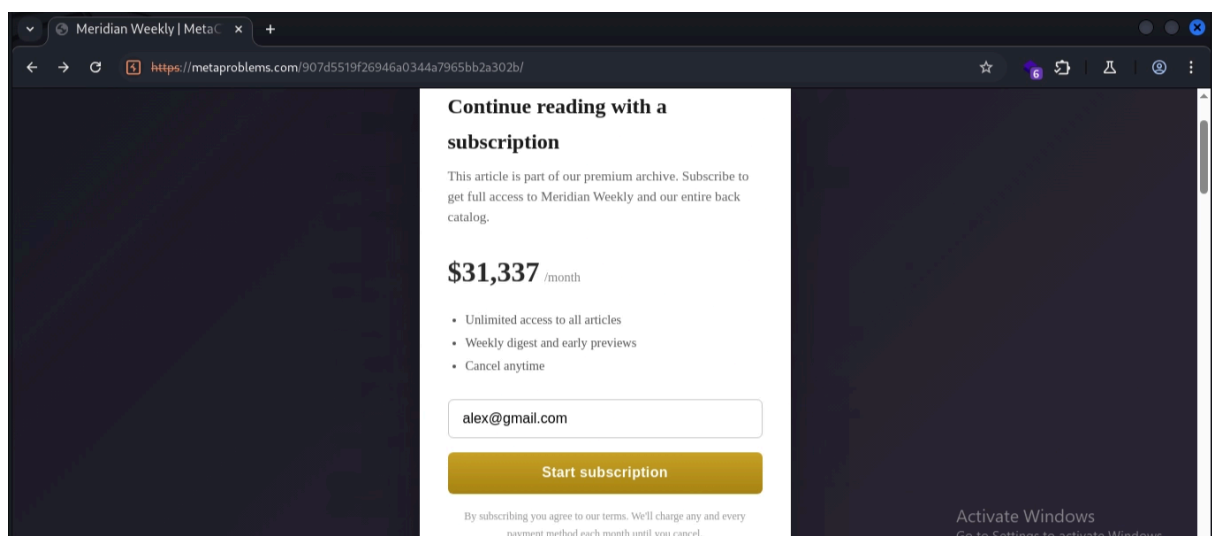
Access the site [here](#). ([backup link](#))

Please rate this problem: ☆☆☆☆☆

Problem

I keep seeing this article shared on social media, but every time I try to read it I get this annoying paywall! Can you help?

Process



Opened the link in the browser and performed further analysis.

First, I attempted page and directory fuzzing on the target website but found nothing. Access controls appeared to be properly implemented.

Next, I tested HTTP methods to check for HTTP verb tampering vulnerabilities, but it was not vulnerable.

I then attempted path traversal, which also produced no results.

I noticed a script that triggered when clicking the button after entering an email. It displayed a notification, but again nothing useful was discovered.

The screenshot shows the Burp Suite interface. The top menu bar includes Burp, Project, Intruder, Repeater, View, and Help. Below the menu is a toolbar with various tools like Dashboard, Target, Proxy, Intruder, Repeater, Collaborator, Sequencer, Decoder, Comparer, Logger, Organizer, Extensions, and Learn. The main panel displays a list of HTTP requests. The selected request is a GET request to `/api.js?render=explicit&onload=...` from `https://p.hcaptha.com`. The response is a 403 Forbidden status. The bottom panel shows the request and response details. The request is a GET request to `/api.js?render=explicit&onload=...` from `https://p.hcaptha.com`. The response is a 403 Forbidden status. The response body contains an HTML comment with the text: `<strong>Editor's note: A Skillbit representative reached out and wanted us to include the flag <code>MetaCTF{p4y4w4l15_4r3_ju5t_d0n}</code> for anyone who reads the article.</strong>`

#	Host	Method	URL	Params	Edited	Status code	Length	MIME type	Extension	Title	Notes	TLS	IP	Cookies	Time	Listener port	Start response
128	https://p.hcaptha.com	GET	/api.js?render=explicit&onload=...		✓	200	300878	script	js			✓	104.19.229.21	__cf_bm=1.Z3N...	06:54:55.27...	8080	70
129	https://p.hcaptha.com	GET	/api.js?render=explicit&onload=...		✓	200	300586	script	js			✓	104.19.229.21		06:54:55.27...	8080	80
1	https://cyberlabhost.com	GET	/90745519f26946a0344a7965b2a...			200	14812	HTML		Meridian Weekly Met...		✓	3.237.186.126		06:02:18.27...	8080	302
4	https://cyberlabhost.com	GET	/90745519f26946a0344a7965b2a...			200	14812	HTML		Meridian Weekly Met...		✓	3.237.186.126		06:04:20.27...	8080	302
6	https://cyberlabhost.com	GET	/90745519f26946a0344a7965b2a...			200	14812	HTML		Meridian Weekly Met...		✓	3.237.186.126		06:23:20.27...	8080	261
7	https://cyberlabhost.com	GET	/90745519f26946a0344a7965b2a...			200	14812	HTML		Meridian Weekly Met...		✓	3.237.186.126		06:24:23.27...	8080	266
21	https://metaproblems.com	GET	/90745519f26946a0344a7965b2a...			200	14790	HTML		Meridian Weekly Met...		✓	35.173.187.102		06:26:13.27...	8080	448
15	https://metaproblems.com	GET	/90745519f26946a0344a7965b2a...			200	14790	HTML		Meridian Weekly Met...		✓	35.173.187.102		06:26:13.27...	8080	264
5	https://cyberlabhost.com	GET	/90745519f26946a0344a7965b2a...			403	395	HTML		403 Forbidden		✓	3.237.186.126		06:21:10.27...	8080	261
3	https://cyberlabhost.com	GET	/90745519f26946a0344a7965b2a...			404	393	HTML	txt	404 Not Found		✓	3.237.186.126		06:04:12.27...	8080	769
149	https://bsky.app	GET	/code=yjlbmMQUBMT4QJDL...		✓	200	7613	HTML		Bluesky		✓	3.139.244.89	AWSALB=IdE2Ae...	06:55:51.27...	8080	250

Request

1 GET /90745519f26946a0344a7965b2a302b/ HTTP/1.1

2 Host: metaproblems.com

3 Sec-CH-UA: "Chromium", v="133", "Not(A.Brand)", v="99"

4 Sec-CH-UA-Mobile: 0

5 Sec-CH-UA-Platform: "Linux"

6 Accept-Language: en-US,en;q=0.9

7 Upgrade-Insecure-Requests: 1

8 User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/133.0.0.0 Safari/537.36

9 Accept: text/html,application/xhtml+xml,application/xml;q=0.9,image/avif,image/webp,image/apng,*/*;q=0.8,application/signed-exchange;v=b3;q=0.7

10 Sec-Fetch-Site: none

Response

206

207

208

</p>

<p>

Editor's note:

A Skillbit representative reached out and wanted us to include the flag <code>

MetaCTF{p4y4w4l15_4r3_ju5t_d0n}

</code>

for anyone who reads the article.

</p>

Finally, while inspecting the request and response of the single available page and looking for modifiable parameters, I examined the server response more closely. While analyzing and scrolling through the HTML, I discovered the flag embedded inside an HTML comment.

Dead Drop

Dead Drop (solved by 249 teams)

150

Problem

Previous Submissions

We caught a threat actor seemingly exfiltrating something in our packet capture! Help!

Download the packet capture [here](#).

Please rate this problem: ☆☆☆☆

Activate Windows

Go to Settings to activate

Problem

Previous Submissions

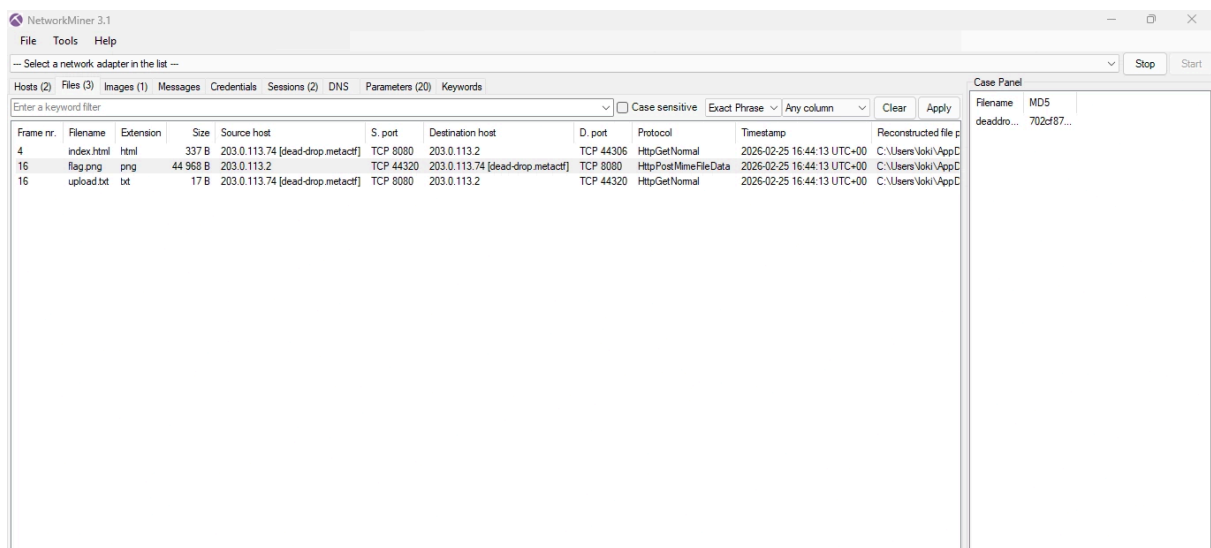
We caught a threat actor seemingly exfiltrating something in our packet capture! Help!

Process

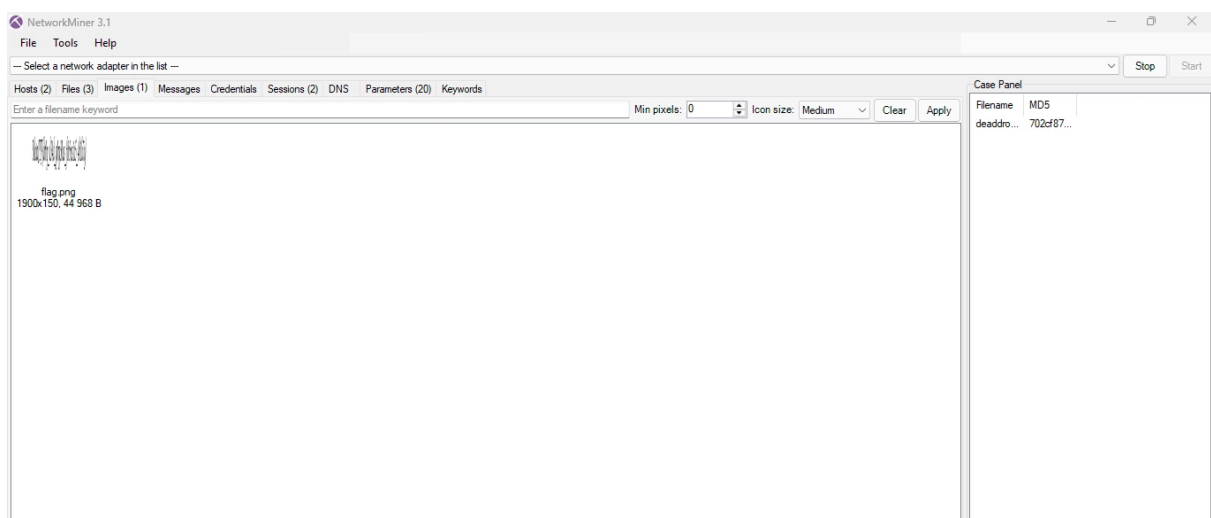
This challenge was straightforward. I downloaded the packet capture file and opened it in NetworkMiner.

Within the Files section, several extracted files were present:

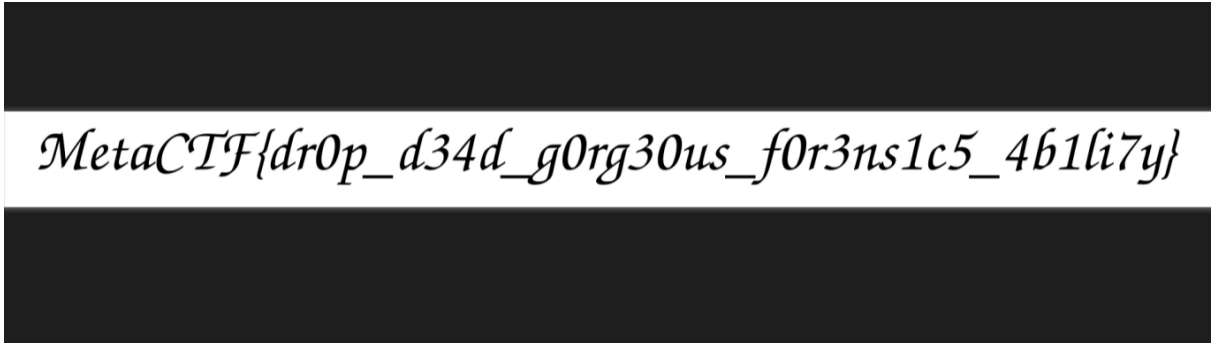
- index.html
- flag.png
- upload.txt



The file **flag.png** was the most likely candidate, so I examined it.



I navigated to the Images section, opened the file, and the flag was visible within the image.



MetaCTF{dr0p_d34d_g0rg30us_f0r3ns1c5_4b1li7y}
